6.4 | CLOSING

LOVING KINDNESS EXERCISE

Participants learn one last stress reduction activity – a Loving Kindness exercise.

This activity helps participants connect with a sense of loving-kindness towards themselves and their children and families. It brings closure to the culminating activity while reconnecting participants to a sense of wellbeing and calmness after all the excitement and anticipation for the closing.

Suggestions for leading the Loving Kindness activity:

NOTE: Use the below text as a guide to leading the activity.

*Just like **Taking a Pause,** you can pause for about 5 seconds at each [Pause] in the text. It is helpful to follow your own instructions during the pause.*

Step 1: Preparation

Sometimes when we are experiencing stress, feeling alone, or just needing support, it can be helpful to send thoughts of loving kindness to ourselves.

This exercise helps us to become more grounded and present – which increases wellbeing and balance – helping us to manage stress, illness, and difficulty. [*Pause*]

Find a comfortable sitting position, your feet flat on the floor, your hands resting in your lap. [*Pause*]

Close your eyes if you feel comfortable. [*Pause*]

Step 2: Becoming Aware

Ask yourself, "What is my experience in this moment?" [*Pause*]

Notice what thoughts you are experiencing. Notice if they are negative or positive. [*Pause*]

Notice how you feel emotionally. Notice if your feelings are pleasant or unpleasant. [*Pause*]

Notice how your body feels. Notice any discomfort or tension. [*Pause*]

Step 3: Opening to Loving Kindness

Connect to your heart in a kind and gentle way. You may want to place one hand on your heart or chest. [*Pause*]

You can then say the following words silently to yourself [*Pause*]

May I be peaceful. [*Pause*]

May I be safe. [*Pause*]

May I be healthy. [*Pause*]

May I be happy. [*Pause*]

May I feel loved. [*Pause*]

Repeat slowly once or twice taking your time between each phrase.

If you feel comfortable, you can also send thoughts of loving-kindness to your children, your partner, your family, and anyone else who is close to you in your life. [*Pause*]

May you be peaceful. [*Pause*]

May you be safe. [*Pause*]

May you be healthy. [*Pause*]

May you be happy. [*Pause*]

May you feel loved. [*Pause*]

Repeat slowly once or twice taking your time between each phrase.

Step 4: Expanding Awareness

Allow your focus to expand to the whole body. [*Pause*]

Allow your focus to expand to the sounds in the room. [*Pause*]

When you are ready, open your eyes. [*Pause*]

Step 5: Reflecting

Take a moment to reflect on your experience.

When you are ready, open your eyes. [*Pause*]

Remember that you can do this activity at any time whenever you feel like you need extra support.

ONGOING HOME ACTIVITIES

IT IS WHAT YOU DO AT HOME THAT MAKES THE DIFFERENCE!

It is important to remind participants that they need to continue keeping their House of Support strong and healthy even though this programme has come to an end.

The home activities are a great way for parents to stay connected to the programme by actively engaging in positive relationship building.

Families should be encouraged to reward themselves whenever they do a home activity!

- Spend **at least 5 minutes** of **One-on-One Time** each day with your child.
- Keep the Sunshine of Positive Attention shining on you and your children.
    - Continue to **praise** your children, yourself, and others in your family
    - Try to **give positive, specific, and realistic instructions** to each other
    - Be **calm and clear** when talking about things that are important to you.
- Continue to build awareness of emotions and your ability to communicate about them
    - Try to be more **aware of your own emotions and the emotions of others.**
    - Ask your child about how they are feeling at least **1 time a week**.
    - Practise **I Feel Statements** when talking about emotions at least **1 time a week**.

- Remember to **Take a Pause** whenever a conflict or difficult situation comes up.

- Try to maintain stable and strong household routines.
  - Be consistent and appreciative with **rules and responsibilities.**
  - Continue to be consistent with **household rules.**

- Work together with your child when experiencing difficulties
  - **Work together** with your child whenever a problem or conflict comes up in your family. **Use the 4 Steps of Problem Solving.**
  - Be realistic, immediate, reasonable, and consistent when using **consequences**.

- Do something nice to **reward yourself** for your hard work in the Mayor Konektà programme!

6.5.| CLOSING CELEBRATION

CERTIFICATES

Hand out certificates of completion to parents at the end of the session. This is a simple recognition for their accomplishment in finishing the programme.

COMPLIMENT CIRCLE

Parents take turns praising each other. Encourage participants to make eye contact and use the name of other participants.

Then parents take turns praising themselves for something specific that they did well.

The compliments can be about anything as long as they are sincere.

EMOTIONAL CHECK-OUT

Model the emotional check-out by describing your emotion, where you feel it in your body, and what thoughts are associated with it.

For example, "I am feeling happy. This happiness is in my eyes. I am happy to have learned about how to create fair rules together."

Thank and praise the families for their commitment to making loving and nurturing relationships together!